INCH-POUND

MIL-F-44367(GL)
27 April 1989

# MILITARY SPECIFICATION

## FOOD PACKET, SUPPLEMENTAL, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT, INDIVIDUAL, ASSEMBLY OF

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. The specification covers the assembly requirements for the supplemental food packet for the Meal, Ready-To-Eat, Individual for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

1.2 Classification. The supplemental packages shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.1).

Type I - With Beef Snacks
Type II - With Granola Bar
Type III - Nut Raisin Mix

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8970

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| A-A-461 | - | Hand Cleaner (Premoistened Paper Towelette in Packet) |
| A-A-20097 | - | Hot Sauce |
| PPP-B-636 | - | Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard |

MILITARY

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-C-10928 | - | Candy and Chocolate Confections |
| MIL-B-35023 | - | Beverage Base Powdered |
| MIL-L-35078 | - | Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items: Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For |
| MIL-O-44136 | - | Oatmeal Cookie and Granola Bars |
| MIL-N-44280 | - | Nut Raisin Mix - (Operational Ration Component) |
| MIL-B-44360 | - | Bread, Shelf Stable for Meal, Ready-To-Eat |

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| FED-STD-595 | - | Colors |

MILITARY

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | - | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes |
| MIL-STD-129 | - | Marking for Shipment and Storage |

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR PArts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

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2.2 Non-Government publications. The following document forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 1505 - Density of Plastics by Density Gradient Technique
F 88 - Seal Strength of Flexible Barrier Materials

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Components.

3.1.1 Packet bag. The packet bag shall be made from polyethylene tubing that is approved for food use and is 0.010 to 0.012-inch thick, with a density of 0.910 to 0.929 gram per centimeter. No area of the bag, including gel-induced depressions, shall be less than 0.010-inch thick. The color of the polyethylene shall be in the range of numbers 34079 through 34102, or 24052 through 24087, or 30045 through 30118 (excluding 30109) or shall conform to number 10045, 20040, 20045, 20062, or 34052 of FED-STD-595. The inside width of the bag shall be not less than 7 inches and not more than 7-5/8 inches and the inside length shall be [illegible]/2 inches (± 1/8 inch). The bag opening shall be across the width. The bag manufacturer's seal shall be a minimum of 1/16 inch wide and located with the outside edge of the seal 1/2 inch (± 1/16 inch) from one end of the bag. The seal shall form a hermetic closure. The entire bag shall show no leakage when tested as specified in 4.2.1.3. The average seal strength of each seal shall be not less than 9 pounds per inch of width and no individual specimen shall be less than 7 pounds (see 4.2.1.2). A 1/4 to 3/8 inch deep slit or V-shaped tear notch shall be located at one end of the bag within 1/2 inch of the longitudinal center line of the bag.

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3.1.1.1 Packet bag marking. Each packet bag shall be printed on at least one face in permanent ink in clear black letters not less than 3/16 inch high, as follows:

FOOD PACKET, SUPPLEMENTAL

TYPE (I, II or III as applicable)

3.1.2 Packet components. The components required for assembly of the supplemental food packet shall be as specified in table I.

TABLE I. Packet components

| Component | Document reference | Used in packet type |
|---|---|---|
| Bread, shelf stable | MIL-B-44360 | I, II and III |
| Beverage base, powdered (one envelope per package) | MIL-B-35023, flavors 1 through 6, (1) 34 gram envelope | I, II and III |
| Hot sauce | A-A-20097, type II, 1/8 fluid ounce bottle | I, II and III |
| Hand cleaner (premoistened paper towelette in packet) | A-A-461 | I, II and III |
| Candy: | MIL-C-10928: | I, II and III |
| Vanilla carmel pieces 1/ (or) | Type III, flavor 3, style 1 (3 or 6 individually wrapped pieces per bar) | |
| Hard candy, fruit tablets 1/ (or) | Type V, class 1, flavor 1, style 1 (10 individually wrapped pieces per bar) | |
| Chocolate rolls 1/ (or) | Type III, flavor 1, style 2 (2 one-half ounce rolls) | |
| Chocolate disks, sugar, pan coated 1/ | Type VI, class 3, style 4 | |
| Beef snacks | 2/ | I |
| Granola bar | MIL-G-44136, type II | II |
| Nut raisin mix | MIL-N-44280 | III |

1/ To be procured in equal quantities and assembled into packets in as uniform a distribution as possible in each shipping container.

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2/ Beef snacks shall be high commercial grade (see 6.2).

3.2 Packet assembly. One each of the applicable components indicated in table I shall be inserted in the packet bag specified in 3.1.1. Excess air shall be expelled prior to closure sealing. The open end of the bag shall be hermetically sealed with a heat seal not less than 1/16 inch wide. The closure seal shall have an average seal strength of not less than 9 pounds per linear inch and no individual specimen shall have a seal strength of less than 7 pounds (see 4.2.3.3). The sealed bag shall not leak when tested in accordance with 4.2.3.1.

3.3 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging, or Holding of Human Food", and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.4 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1.1 Material certification. A certificate of compliance may be acceptable as evidence that the characteristics listed below conform to the specified requirements.



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| Requirement | Requirement paragraph | Test procecure |
|---|---|---|
| Packet bag material: | | |
| Identification | 3.1.1 | Laboratory evaluation |
| Thickness | 3.1.1 | Laboratory evaluation |
| Color | 3.1.1 | Visual evaluation |

4.2.1.2 Unfilled packet bag seal strength testing. The unfilled bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with Method B of ASTM F 88 except that the specimen holding clamps shall be spaced 2 inches apart prior to testing and the testing speed shall be 10 or 12 inches per minute. Machines that apply the tensile load to the test specimen by movement of the upper or lower clamp may be used. One-half or 1 inch wide test specimens shall be cut to a length suitable for proper mounting. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled packet bag. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Three adjacent specimens 1/2 or 1 inch wide, shall be cut from the sealed side of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch or width. The average seal strength shall be calculated by averaging the three test specimens cut from that seal. Any test specimen or average seal strength failing to meet the requirements specified in 3.1.1 shall be classified as a major defect.

4.2.1.3 Unfilled packet bag seal leakage testing. The packet bags shall be tested for leakage of the manufacturer's seal. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled packet bag. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Each sample bag shall be filled with a test load, have excess air expelled, and have a closure seal applied to the open end. The test load shall be fiberboard or other rigid material which is 4-1/2 inches wide by 4 inches in length and 2 inches in height (to approximate the dimensions of the packet bag contents). The sample bag shall then be submerged in water in a desiccator or other suitable container under a vacuum of 15 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage. Any sign of leakage shall be classified as a major defect.

4.2.2 Shipping container inspection.

4.2.2.1 Shipping container examination. Examination of the filled and closed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination:



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Major - National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
- Metal fasteners used in closing the box.
- Outer flaps do not completely meet, leaving an opening greater than 1/2 inch between flaps ends.

Minor - Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.

4.2.2.2 Shipping container interior examination. The filled and sealed shipping containers shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed shipping container. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects.

TABLE II. Shipping container interior defects

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | More or less than 24 packets |
| 102 | Not eight of each packet type |
| 103 | Not packed or arranged as specified |
| 104 | Box liner missing |

4.2.3 Packet bag inspection.

4.2.3.1 Packet bag leakage testing. The filled and sealed packet bags shall be tested for leakage by submerging in water contained in a desiccator or other suitable container under a vacuum of 15 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage. Any bag with one or more leaks shall be counted as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.2.3.2 Packet bag examination. The filled and sealed packet bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects. The sample packet bags shall be selected from shipping containers which have been filled and sealed. The inspection sample shall contain a proportionate amount of each of the three packet types.

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TABLE III. Packet bag defects 1/

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major | Minor | |
| 101 | | Packet bag not formed as specified |
| 102 | | Missing component |
| 103 | | Incorrect content for packet type |
| 104 | | Excess air remaining in bag after final closure |
| 105 | | Closure not heat sealed |
| 106 | | Seal widths less than specified |
| 107 | | Distance from outside edge of bottom seal to end of bag not as specified |
| 108 | | Tear, hole, or split in packet bag |
| 109 | | Foreign odor |
| 110 | | Not clean - the packet bag or any of the outer packaging of its contents 2/ |
| 111 | | Labeling missing, incorrect, or illegible |
| 112 | | Tear, hole, or puncture in bread pouch, in candy package, or in beverage base, beef jerky, granola, or nut raisin mix bag |
| 113 | | Plastic shrink film missing from around screw cap of hot sauce bottle |
| | 201 | More than the required number of components |
| | 202 | Contents caught in packet bag closure seal |
| | 203 | Tear notch or slit missing or not positioned as specified |
| | 204 | Dimensions of tear notch or slit not as specified |
| | 205 | Tear, hole or puncture in towelette envelope |

1/ Examination of packet bags shall be made after shipping container is filled and closed.



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2/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause pouch damage (i.e., glass, metal filings, etc.), or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the package. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential pouch damage and which can be readily removed by gently shaking the package or by gently brushing the package with a clean dry cloth.

b. Localized dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one pouch face, or an aggregate of scattered dried product which affects less than 1/4 of the total surface area of one pouch face.

c. Water spots.

d. Very thin film of grease, oil, or product residue which is discernible to touch, but is not readily discernible by visual examination.

4.2.3.3 Packet bag closure seal strength testing. The filled and sealed packet bags shall be tested for closure seal strength in accordance with Method B of ASTM F 88 except that the specimen holding clamps shall be spaced 2 inches apart prior to testing and the testing speed may be 10 or 12 inches per minute. Machines that apply the tensile load to the test specimen by movement of the upper or lower clamp may be used. One-half or 1 inch wide test specimens shall be cut to a length suitable for proper mounting. Three adjacent specimens, 1/2 or 1 inch wide, shall be cut from the closure seal of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width for each specimen and for the average of the three specimens from each closure seal. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet bag. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5. Any test specimen or average seal strength failing to meet the requirements specified in 3.2 shall be classified as a major defect.

4.2.4 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Twenty-four food packets, eight of each type (see 1.2) shall be packed on edge, eight in length, three in width, and one in depth, in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V3c of PPP-B-636, except that metal fasteners shall not be used. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to grade V3c of PPP-B-636. The inside dimensions of the fiberboard shipping container shall be 20 inches in length, 16 inches in width, and 6-5/8 inches in depth. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III and waterproofed with tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.2 Unit loads. The supplemental food packets, packed as specified in 5.1, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with type I, class B of MIL-L-35078.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Unit loads. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type (see 1.2).
c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).

6.2 Beef snacks. The following beef snacks have been found to be satisfactory in previous evaluations:

Smokecraft, product code 6030, Albany, Oregon 97321
Lowrey's, product code 50541, Denver, Colorado
Texas Star Brand Beef Jerkey, manufactured by Newman Meats, Brenham, Texas 77833

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Operational rations
Shelf stable

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:
Army - GL

(Project 8970-A148)

Review activities:
Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS



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*NOTE:* This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

*(See Instructions – Reverse Side)*

| 1. DOCUMENT NUMBER | 2. DOCUMENT TITLE |
|---|---|
| MIL-F-44367(GL) | Food Packet, Supplemental for Meal, Ready-To-Eat, Individual Assembly Of |

| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
|---|---|
| | ☐ VENDOR<br>☐ USER<br>☐ MANUFACTURER<br>☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____ |
| b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | |

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
|---|---|
| c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional | 8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)* |

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